HAMASPIK LEOVDEI HASHEM

The Correct Attitude to Bitahon: Trust Hashem, Use the Means

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Sefer: HaMaspik L'Ovdei Hashem (Kifayat al-Abidin) — Rabbi Avraham ben HaRambam **Chapter:** Perek 8 (ביטחון — Bitachon and Reliance) — Part 2 **This Week:** Category 2 (The Bitachon of the Heretics) · Category 3 (The Correct Bitachon Expected of Us) · Balancing Effort and Trust

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Recap from Part 1

The Definition of Bitachon

Complete reliance on Hakadosh Baruch Hu — He is the Creator of all, and everything in the universe is subservient to His will. Living with this brings security and serenity. We may **use** the mediums Hashem created (medicine, doctors, work) — but we do not place our **reliance** on them.

The Three Categories Framework

Category	Who	Status
1	The Prophets — divested from natural means, relied on miracles **by divine instruction** (prophecy or Ruach HaKodesh)	The highest level — forbidden for anyone not instructed
2	**Tonight** — the heretics	The wrong bitachon
3	**Tonight** — what's expected of us	The correct bitachon

Key Point from Part 1

A person without prophecy or Ruach HaKodesh is **forbidden** to rely on miracles — that's brazenness (chutzpah) leading to chillul Hashem.

PART 1 — Category 2: The Bitachon of the Heretics (ביטחון של הכופרים)

החלק השני הוא הפוכו של החלק הראשון — בטחונם של הכופרים והנלווים עליהם באמצעים הקרובים החיצוניים והרגילים, בעוד שבפנימיותם אינם בוטחים בהשם יתעלה

The second category is the opposite of the first — the trust of the deniers and those like them, in the proximate, external, regular intermediaries — while inwardly they do not trust in Hashem.

Important Framing

We are NOT discussing outright atheists — that's a failure of **Emunah**, a different discussion entirely. Bitachon is the level *after* Emunah. **Category 2 describes people who believe in God but place their actual trust in intermediaries.**

The Telltale Signs

כגון מי שבוטח בעניין פרנסתו רק על מאמציו, ובשעת מחלתו רק ברופאו וברפואותיו

- **Livelihood**: "How much money I make depends *entirely* on how hard I work"
- **Illness**: All trust placed in the doctor and the medicine

(You might think — of course income depends on effort! We'll refine this in Category 3. The error is the word ONLY — when you believe it depends completely and solely on the effort/doctor/medicine.)

Category 2 Has Two Forms

Form 2A — Open Denial (כפירה גלויה): The Greek Philosophers

כדרך שמצינו בפילוסופי יוון... שחכמתם נעוצה בדברים שבטבע ובאמצעים רגילים, וכופרים בהשגחתו הפרטית של השם יתעלה על מעשי בני אדם

The position of **Aristotle** and his followers: Yes, there is a God — a Prime Mover (*Matzui Rishon*), an ultimate existence behind the universe. **But once He created it, the universe runs purely by the laws of nature.** Effort in → money out. Medicine in → health out. There is no hashgachah pratit (individual providence) over human affairs — so there is nothing to rely on God *for*.

Form 2B — Hidden Denial (כפירה נסתרת): The Subtle Trap

כגון מי שתראהו בוטח בהשם יתעלה מן השפה ולחוץ

The person who trusts Hashem from the lips outward.

He *says* all the right things:

ויאמר שהשם מפרנס ומכלכל, מחיה וממית, מוחץ ומרפא

"Hashem provides and sustains, gives life and death, wounds and heals" — Baruch Hashem! B'ezrat Hashem!

But deep in his heart (בסתר לבו):

- His parnassah → really depends on his own acquisitions and schemes
- In illness → really depends only on the doctors
- In war → really depends only on strength and strategy

This is the subtle form of denial that we ourselves can fall into.

What Tanakh Says About Category 2

Source	Verse	Message
Tehillim	אין אלהים כל מזמותיו	David calls such people *wicked*
Tehillim	שנאתי השומרים הבלי שוא, ואני אל ה' בטחתי	*"I hate those who rely on vain follies — I trust in Hashem"*
Devarim (Eikev)	השמר לך פן תשכח את ה' אלהיך... ואמרת בלבבך כחי ועצם ידי עשה לי את החיל הזה	The Torah's warning: when you prosper in the Land, don't say *"my own strength made me this wealth"*
Devarim	וזכרת את ה' אלהיך כי הוא הנותן לך כח לעשות חיל	*"Remember Hashem — HE gives you the strength to make wealth"*
Tehillim	אל תבטחו בנדיבים, בבן אדם שאין לו תשועה	*"Do not trust in nobles, in a human who has no salvation"*
Yeshayahu	חדלו לכם מן האדם אשר נשמה באפו, כי במה נחשב הוא	*"Cease relying on man, whose breath is in his nostrils"*
Tehillim	הנה הגבר לא ישים אלהים מעוזו, ויבטח ברב עשרו	The man who doesn't make God his stronghold, and trusts his wealth
Tehillim	חיל כי ינוב אל תשיתו לב	*"When wealth increases, do not set your heart on it"*
Iyov	אם שמתי זהב כסלי, ולכתם אמרתי מבטחי	Iyov's self-defense: *"Did I make gold my security? I did not!"*
Yirmiyahu	**ארור הגבר אשר יבטח באדם** ושם בשר זרועו, **ומן ה' יסור לבו**	*"Cursed is the man who trusts in man... AND turns his heart from Hashem"*

The Rambam's Crucial Reading of "Arur HaGever" (Quoted by His Son)

Rabbi Avraham quotes his father (the Rambam) on the verse *"Cursed is the man who trusts in man... and from Hashem turns his heart"*:

כי לולא המילים "ומן ה' יסור לבו" — היו כלולים בכלל זה רוב בני אדם, ואפילו כולם

If not for the words "and turns his heart from Hashem" — nearly EVERY person would fall under this curse!

Because in normal life:

a child relies on a parent — **הבן בוטח על אביו**
a wife relies on her husband (for livelihood, in the historical context) — **והאשה על בעלה**
a business partner relies on his partner — **והשותף על שותפו**

The Resolution

ואילו הקללה נוגעת אך ורק במי שמצמצם בטחונו בבני אדם — **ולא** במי שבוטח בפנימיותו שהשם יתעלה, ורק נעזר בבני אדם ומשתמש באמצעים

The curse applies ONLY to one who confines his trust to humans alone — not to one who inwardly trusts Hashem and merely makes use of people and means.

- A child trusting a parent → fine — knowing Hashem is the ultimate source
- A sick person hiring the best doctor → fine — knowing healing is ultimately from Hashem
- It is the *exclusivity* of the trust in the intermediary that constitutes the curse

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The Diagnostic Test — How to Know If You're in Category 2B

Rabbi Kada's sharpening of the distinction:

Scenario: Someone is seriously ill. They search relentlessly for the best doctor, willing to turn everything upside down. — *That's fine. That's Category 3.*

But now: Despite everything, the best doctor is unavailable — can't come, can't be paid, whatever. The person thinks: *"Oh no — NOW I have less chance of getting better."*

That thought reveals Category 2B. You said you trusted Hashem — but your sense of security was actually pinned to the doctor. If you truly trusted Hashem, then having done everything in your power, you'd hand the rest to Him with equanimity.

PART 2 — Category 3: The Correct Bitachon (What's Expected of Us)

The third category is the bitachon **והסוג השלישי הרי הוא הבטחון המוטל על כל שומרי התורה** *.incumbent upon all who keep the Torah*

The Definition

והוא שיהא נטוע באמונתו של אדם וברור בלבו, שהעילות הטבעיות... מסורים ביד השגחה אלוקית פרטית לגבי כל אחד ואחד, בכל זמן וכל מצב

It must be planted in a person's faith and clear in his heart that ALL the natural causes are in the hands of Hashem's individual providence — for each person, at every time, in every situation.

- **By Hashem's will** → the natural causes run their regular, pre-set course (the overwhelming majority of the time)
- **By Hashem's will** → occasionally, rarely, they deviate from their regular course

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The Health Mashal (Analogy)

The Facts of Nature (as known then)

- Good bread, lamb, and wine → produce good blood, health, and strength
- Beans, lentils, spoiled meat, old wine → damage the blood; habitual consumption → illness
- Bloodletting when veins are full → restores health
- Laxatives when the body has excess → cleanse it

- Cooling medicines for fever; warming ones for chills → restore health

(Today's equivalents: vitamin C for colds, the right medicine for the right illness, a good diet, etc. — these are facts of medical science.)

The Critical Addition

כל הגורמים הטבעיים הללו כפופים לרצונו יתעלה ALL these natural causes are subservient to His will.

ועל פי פקודת רצונו פועלים הם על רוב בני אדם... ובפקודת רצונו פועלים הם לפעמים בדרך הפוכה ממה שהיה מצופה

By His will they work in the vast majority of cases (99.9%). And by His will they sometimes work in the **opposite** way from what was expected.

The Two Directions

If Hashem has decreed someone be punished with illness:

אפילו יאכל מאכלים משופרא דשופרא — הרי הם מחוללים בו דם נשחת... אפילו אם יקח סמי מרפא לא יועילו לו

- Even the finest foods will generate bad blood
- Even the best medicines won't help — *"He cannot heal you, nor cure you of your wound"* (Hoshea)

If Hashem has decreed someone be healthy:

אפילו יאכל מאכלים נפסדים בהיותו אנוס לכך — לא ישחיתו דמו

- Even bad food (eaten under duress — when there's no choice) won't make him ill
- As the verse says: **כל המחלה אשר שמתי במצרים לא אשים עליך, כי אני ה' רופאך** — *"I will not place upon you the diseases of Egypt, for I am Hashem your healer"*
- And: **והסיר ה' ממך כל חולי** — *"Hashem will remove from you all illness"*

Note the qualifier — בהיותו אנוס לכך (under duress): You cannot eat junk daily and say "I trust in Hashem" — that's demanding a miracle (Category 1 behavior without authorization). The promise applies to extenuating circumstances.

Even Brief Illness

וגם אם נפל למשכב... יתרפא בלא תרופה, ובתרופה פשוטה ובדבר פשוט

If Hashem decreed a brief illness as a reminder — the person will recover easily, even without medicine or with a simple one. As Chazal expound: *"I will not place illness upon you — and if I do, אני ה' רופאך, I am your Healer."*

The Rabbi Chanina ben Dosa Illustration

The Gemara tells: Rabbi Chanina ben Dosa came home one Friday and his wife had no oil for the Shabbat candles. He said over the water (the Gemara's version: vinegar): **"The One who told oil to burn can tell water to burn"** — and it lit.

The Lesson

It is not the oil that produces the flame — it is the will of Hashem that oil produces flame. Oil is the natural medium we are commanded to operate through. But when a person of that level

has exhausted every natural possibility, the underlying truth shows itself: nature is nothing but Hashem's standing will.

(Obviously — we don't do this. The point is the principle, not the practice.)

The Parnassah Mashal

The Facts of Agriculture (as known then)

מדרך הטבע הוא שהתבואה הנזרעת... תיתן שבעה שערים או לכל היותר עשרה שערים

Normal planting yields **sevenfold, at most tenfold** return.

The Two Directions

One cursed (who transgressed):

He plants a measure (ardab) and harvests **half** of what he planted — יזרע ארדב ויאסוף מחציתה בלבד
as it says: **זרע רב תוציא השדה ומעט תאסוף** — *"You will sow much and gather little"*

One blessed:

He plants one measure and harvests **twentyfold** — יזרע ארדב ויאסוף עשרים — *"ברכת ה' היא תעשיר"*
'The blessing of Hashem enriches"

The Ultimate Example — Yitzchak and Me'ah She'arim

ויזרע יצחק בארץ ההיא וימצא בשנה ההיא מאה שערים, ויברכהו ה' *"Yitzchak planted in that land and*
"found in that year a HUNDREDFOLD — and Hashem blessed him

When the norm is 7-10x, Yitzchak received **100x** — ten times the maximum. *(This is where the name of the Yerushalayim neighborhood "Me'ah She'arim" comes from — a hundredfold of blessing.)*

The same applies to children, flocks and herds, trade, seafaring — all dependent on Hashem's will.

The Practical Conduct of Category 3

חייב אפוא שומר הדת, בשעה שהוא מקדיש את חילו לגורמים טבעיים... **שבטחונו על השם יתעלה ולא לבו תלוי** בהפקת התועלת

When engaging the natural means (for health or livelihood) — your trust must be on Hashem, not your heart hanging on the means themselves.

The Chazal Institution — The Yehi Ratzon Before Medicine

הנכנס להקיז דם אומר: יהי רצון מלפניך ה' אלהי שיהא עסק זה לי לרפואה

One entering bloodletting (= medical treatment) says: *"May it be Your will, Hashem my God, that this engagement be for my healing."*

Modern application: When taking a pill, say the Yehi Ratzon. It's not merely a prayer — it's a **recalibration**: reminding yourself that whether the medicine works depends on Hashem, even as you faithfully use the means He created.

ההולך למוד את גורנו אומר: יהי רצון שתשלח ברכה במעשה ידינו

Checking your threshing floor (= modern: going to a job interview, launching a venture): *"May it be Your will to send blessing in the work of my hands."* You prepared everything you could — and you hand the outcome to Hashem.

ומתוך הפרטים האלו תקיש לדומיהם — extrapolate from these examples to everything else.

The Constant Reminder

וצריך שיהיה דבר זה חוזר במחשבתו של אדם בשעת המעשה וקבוע בלבו, כדי שלא יתעלם ממנו

This must recur in a person's thoughts at the time of the action and be fixed in his heart — so it doesn't slip away.

It is *very easy* to slide into Category 2B — saying "B'ezrat Hashem" while actually pinning your security on this doctor, that medicine, this deal. The remedy is **active, repeated reminding** at the moment of engagement.

The Anti-Extremism Consequence

ואז לא ילהט יותר מדי אחרי התחבולות והסיבות

When you live with this attitude, you won't chase the means obsessively or disproportionately.

Health Example

You're ill; you found and hired a very good doctor. There exists a *marginally* better one — but reaching him means selling your house, extreme upheaval, for an extra couple of percent. **That's too far.** You've genuinely done what's expected; the disproportionate extra is a Category 2 behavior (acting as if it ALL hangs on the human means).

Parnassah Example

Yes — work hard (this is about to be emphasized strongly). But you are not expected to work 6 AM to 10 PM. What about Torah? What about tefillah? **Balance.** Do your normal, honest effort — then step back.

כמו שאמרו חז"ל: הוי ממעט בעסק ועסוק בתורה — *Minimize business and engage in Torah*

Fear Also Returns to the Source

פלטה נפשי מרשע **חרבך** — (David) *"Save my soul from the wicked — from YOUR sword"*

Even the wicked man's sword is ultimately **Hashem's sword** — it can only harm if Hashem removes His protection. So even fear is redirected to its true address.

Kohelet's Summary of Natural Limits

שבתי וראה תחת השמש: **כי לא לקלים המרוץ, ולא לגיבורים המלחמה, וגם לא לחכמים לחם, וגם לא לנבונים עושר, וגם לא ליודעים חן — כי עת ופגע יקרה את כולם**

"The race is not to the swift, nor the battle to the strong, nor bread to the wise, nor riches to the intelligent, nor favor to the knowledgeable — for time and chance happen to them all."

Statistically, the strong win battles. But not always — because the outcome is Hashem's.

The Chiddush — Hashem Provides for Those Who Trust

Rabbi Avraham now reveals something beyond mere theology — a *practical promise*:

The Verse (Tehillim 127)

אם ה' לא יבנה בית — שוא עמלו בוניו בו; אם ה' לא ישמר עיר — שוא שקד שומר

"If Hashem does not build a house — its builders toil in vain; if Hashem does not guard a city — the watchman watches in vain."

(Modern application: without Hashem's will, the best Iron Dome and the best military cannot protect.)

The Key Verse

שוא לכם משכימי קום מאחרי שבת אוכלי לחם העצבים — כן יתן לידידו שנה

"In vain do you rise early, stay up late, eat the bread of anxiety — for He gives to His beloved ones sleep."

Rabbi Avraham's Interpretation

הוי המתחכמים להשגת משאלותיכם הגשמיות, וקמים באשמורת הלילה... לשוא כל שקידתכם אם לא יצטרף אליה עזר משמים. **ואילו הייתם מאלה האהובים עליו יתעלה — בזכות בטחונכם בו היתה מספקת לכם יגיעה מועטת, ויכולתם לישון בשלוה**

Woe to those who wake before dawn and return home late at night, eating their bread in stress — all your diligence is in vain without Heaven's help. But were you among His beloved — in the merit of your bitachon, MINIMAL effort would suffice, and you could sleep in tranquility.

כי באמת נכון הדבר שהשם יתעלה מספק לאהובים עליו את כל צורכיהם... בלי יגיעה וטורח

It is truly so: Hashem supplies all the needs of those beloved to Him — without excessive toil.

בשלום יחדיו אשכבה ואישן, כי אתה ה' לבדד לבטח תושיבני" *In peace I lie down and sleep — for You alone,"* *"Hashem, settle me in security*

PART 3 — The Critical Counterbalance: This Is NOT a License for Laziness

ואין כוונת הפסוקים... כי מפני בטחונו רשאי שומר התורה לשבת בחיבוק ידיים

Do not conclude from these verses (e.g., השלך על ה' יהבך והוא יכלכלך — "Cast your burden on Hashem and He will sustain you") that one may sit with folded hands and wait for food to fall from heaven like the man, or be delivered by ravens like Eliyahu.

That is a level not everyone can attain — it's Category 1, **כי זו מדרגה שלא כל אחד יכול להשיגה** .requiring prophecy/Ruach HaKodesh

The Proof — The Greatest Sages All Worked

Figure	Occupation
Hillel	Wood-chopper
Karna	Water-carrier
Rabbi Yehoshua	Coal merchant
Abba Chilkiya	Day-laborer plowman — *the same Abba Chilkiya whose prayer brought rain in a drought!*

Even the Avot and Prophets Worked

Figure	Occupation	Source
Noach	Worked the ground	ויחל נח איש האדמה ויטע כרם (Onkelos: גבר פלח בארעא)
Avraham	Shepherd/cattle	רועי מקנה אברם
Yitzchak	Farmer	ויזרע יצחק בארץ ההיא
Yaakov	Shepherd (20 years for Lavan)	מתי אעשה גם אנכי לביתי — *"When shall I provide for my own house?"*
Moshe Rabbeinu — the master of prophets	Shepherd for Yitro	

Chazal's Praise of Honest Work

יגיע כפיך כי תאכל — אשריך וטוב לך *"When you eat the toil of your hands — fortunate are you and good is yours"*

The Gemara (Berachot):

גדול הנהנה מיגיעו יותר מירא שמים *Greater is one who benefits from his own labor than one who fears Heaven!*

For the God-fearer it says only *"Fortunate is the man who fears Hashem"* — but for the one who eats his own toil: **אשריך בעולם הזה, וטוב לך לעולם הבא** — *fortunate in THIS world, and good in the NEXT world.*

Don't Confuse the Lazy Man with the Man of Bitachon

הישמר פן יתחלף לך בין העצל הראוי לגנאי ובין בעל ביטחון הראוי לשבח

Beware of confusing the lazy person (deserving condemnation) with the person of bitachon (deserving praise).

Shlomo HaMelech in Mishlei:

Verse	Message
אוגר בקיץ בן משכיל, נרדם בקציר בן מביש	The wise son gathers in summer; the shameful one sleeps through harvest
אל תאהב שנה פן תורש; פקח עיניך שבע לחם	*"Don't love sleep lest you become poor; open your eyes and be satisfied with bread"*
עובד אדמתו ישבע לחם, ומרדף ריקים ישבע ריש	*"One who works his land is satisfied with bread; one who chases empty things is satisfied with poverty"*

"One who chases empty things" (מרדף ריקים) = those who imagine themselves worthy of miracles, or hold a vain, idle "bitachon."

The Chillul Hashem Warning — Painfully Relevant Today

ואם יחשוב כל אדם כי ראוי הוא לחסד אלוה כפי אליהו ואלישע — **יהיה ללעג ולקלס**

One who fancies himself worthy of Eliyahu-and-Elisha-level providence **will be mocked.** About such people: **דור טהור בעיניו ומצואתו לא רוחץ** — *"a generation pure in its own eyes, yet unwashed of its filth."*

The Mechanism of the Chillul Hashem

כי הרשעים רואים את שפל מצבם... והם נזקקים לנדבותיהם

The non-religious see those who claim devotion to God **dependent on the donations and charity of the very people whose lifestyle they reject.** What conclusion does the benefactor draw? — *"Apparently it really IS all up to me and my effort."* This **doubles down their materialism** and desecrates Hashem's name.

(Rabbi Kada: This is before even discussing those who twist and lie to systems to live off benefits — which is plainly wrong. Even legitimately relying on donations from those you consider to be living wrongly, when avoidable, sends this corrosive message. ודי למבין.)

But Also — Don't Become Addicted to Work

ואין דברי שלמה בשבח העבודה... מחייבים התמכרות למעשה

Shlomo praised work — but **never said "toil to become rich":**

> **אל תיגע להעשיר** — *"Do not toil to become rich"* **טוב מעט ביראת ה' מאוצר רב ומהומה בו** — *"Better a little with fear of Hashem than great treasure with turmoil"*

The Balanced Formula

שיעבוד האדם למחייתו באמצעים רגילים **בלי הפרזה יתירה**... ויקדיש רוב עתותיו לתורה ולמצוותיה

1. Work for your livelihood through normal means — **without excess**
2. Recognize deep down the Torah principle of bitachon
3. Dedicate the majority of your free time to Torah and mitzvot

Pirkei Avot's Framework

יפה תלמוד תורה עם דרך ארץ, שיגיעת שניהם משכחת עוון. וכל תורה שאין עמה מלאכה — סופה בטלה וגוררת עוון

Torah study with worldly occupation is beautiful — the toil of both banishes sin. Torah without work ends in nullity and drags sin behind it.

אם אין קמח אין תורה; אם אין תורה אין קמח *.No flour, no Torah; no Torah, no flour*

The Rambam's Daily Schedule (for his era)

- 24 hours: **8 hours sleep** (the Rambam writes this!)
- ~4 hours for prayer and necessities
- Of the remaining 12: **3 hours work, 9 hours study**
- The 9 study-hours: 3 Torah (Tanakh), 3 Talmud, 3 intellectual inference and wisdom

(Times differ — modern employment doesn't map onto this. The principle stands: work what's needed; devote free time to Torah.)

The Closing Warnings — Avoiding Both Extremes

השמר פן תשקע ראשך ורובך בסיבות עבודת הפרנסה — פן תהיה עם אותם הכופרים

Don't sink head-and-shoulders into the pursuit of livelihood — or you slide into Category 2 ("it all depends on my work"), about whom it says: הבוטחים על חילם וברוב עשרם יתהללו.

ולא תנהג בבורות ותחזיק עזות פנים לסמוך על הביטחון בלבד בלי השקעה בעבודה

And don't act with ignorant brazenness, relying on bitachon alone without working — that's Category 1, requiring sanctification and levels you have not attained.

The Conclusion — The Formula for True Bitachon

ראה את הביטחון בהשם יתעלה כמחייב אותך לסמוך עליו תוך כדי עיסוק באומנות רגילה, והצטמצם במלאכה פשוטה שהיא טורדך מעבודתו יתעלה כדי חייך — אזי תהיה בעל ביטחון אמיתי

See bitachon as obligating you to rely on Hashem WHILE engaged in a normal occupation. Confine yourself to straightforward work sufficient for your needs (so you never become dependent on others) — then you will be a possessor of TRUE bitachon.

And from there one can rise higher — if Hashem so wills in His kindness — toward sustenance with minimal toil:

ברוך הגבר אשר יבטח בה', והיה ה' מבטחו *"Blessed is the man who trusts in Hashem — and Hashem will be his security"*

The Future Promise

וכבר הבטיח השם יתעלה לישראל כי לעתיד יופיע להם השגחתו... ויבטל בטחונם בגורם אחר

In the Messianic future, Hashem's providence will be manifest and **all reliance on intermediaries will fall away** — everyone will reach Category 1:

והיה שארית יעקב... כטל מאת ה', כרביבים עלי עשב, אשר לא יקוה לאיש ולא ייחל לבני אדם *"The remnant of Yaakov will be like dew from Hashem, like raindrops on grass — which hopes not in man and waits not for humans"*

Just as rain depends on no human hand — so will our trust be purely in Hashem.

Summary

Category 2 — The Wrong Bitachon (Heretics)

- **2A — Open**: The Greek philosophers — God exists but the world runs purely by nature; no individual providence
- **2B — Hidden**: Saying "B'ezrat Hashem" outwardly while inwardly pinning security on effort, doctors, medicine, wealth
- The curse of ארור הגבר applies only when trust in humans **replaces** Hashem (ומן ה' יסור לבו) — using people and means while trusting Hashem is fine
- **The test**: when the best means become unavailable after full effort — do you panic (2B) or hand it to Hashem with equanimity (3)?

Category 3 — The Correct Bitachon (For All Torah-Keepers)

- All natural causes are subservient to Hashem's individual providence, for every person, at every moment
- Normally nature runs its course; Hashem can redirect it at any time (in both directions — for blessing or its opposite)
- **Engage the means fully** — medicine, doctors, honest work — while your trust rests on Hashem
- Say the **Yehi Ratzon** when taking medicine or beginning a venture — the recalibration matters
- **Don't go overboard** in pursuit of health or wealth — disproportionate chasing reveals misplaced trust
- **The chiddush**: Hashem supplies the needs of those who truly trust Him — with reduced toil ("He gives to His beloved sleep")
- **Not laziness**: Hillel chopped wood; the Avot herded sheep; Moshe shepherded for Yitro. Relying on miracles without authorization = mockery + chillul Hashem
- **The formula**: normal work without excess + majority of free time in Torah + heart fixed on Hashem = true bitachon

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Coming Up Next Week

Continuing Chapter 8 — further development of the laws and attitudes of Bitachon.

(Schedule note: Moreh tomorrow (Tuesday) 8:00pm; no shiur this Thursday; regular schedule resumes next week — Monday, Tuesday, Thursday.)

B'Ezrat Hashem

Watch or listen to this shiur: youtu.be/RIY2IDehgtk · More shiurim: rabbikada.com